

Title

Systematic adaptation of a palliative care intervention for implementation across seven European countries: outcomes from the Pal-Cycles partnership

Abstract

Background: Successful implementation of complex healthcare interventions across diverse settings requires culturally responsive adaptation. We report findings from adapting the Pal-Cycles intervention across seven European countries. **Methods:** A total of 36 clinical leaders and 14 patient/family representatives participated in structured adaptation meetings over 4 months. Each country's working group addressed five core intervention components: assessment protocols, communication frameworks, care planning templates, professional training modules, and patient information resources. Nominal group technique facilitated prioritized refinement of elements. Outcomes included consensus achievement and production of country-specific intervention manuals. **Results:** All seven countries successfully developed adapted intervention manuals maintaining core theoretical components while reflecting local healthcare architecture, regulatory requirements, and cultural end-of-life perspectives. Key adaptations included translation of outcome measures, alignment with local care pathways, and integration of existing professional roles. All countries achieved consensus on core intervention elements (100% agreement on 4 of 5 components). Qualitative feedback indicated strong perceived relevance and feasibility for local implementation. **Conclusion:** Systematic multi-stakeholder engagement enables effective adaptation of palliative interventions across heterogeneous European contexts while preserving intervention integrity.